

2025 Budget Hearings September 13th

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jZ43WkvySdc
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Delaware County Council Budget Hearing Meeting Summary

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at [00:00:26](#) as a session of the Delaware County Council budget hearing.
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Mr. Webb, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Byrd, Mr. Freeman, and other council members responding to roll call.
 - Presiding Officer: Explicitly identified via council dialogue (e.g., Mr. Webb, Mr. Hughes).
 - Staff Present: Jessica (Council/Budget staff), Matt, Ed, Elizabeth (Auditor's office), and Tanya.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not applicable to this budget work session.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed in this transcript segment.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:32](#) Public Defender Budget Review & Adjustments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Public Defender.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Harvey reviewed proposed changes to the public defender budget, including reducing attorney salary requests to \$52,000 (excepting the mandated chief public defender salary), setting legal secretary C/assistants to \$42,000 (factoring in alignment with the investigator midpoint), and adjusting her own salary request to \$53,100 based on supervisory and financial duties compared to similar directors. The resulting general fund request totals \$2,048,329, which is approximately \$517,000 more than last year and 40% reimbursable, providing raises to 25 county employees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation and review; incorporated into working budget calculations without a formal standalone vote.
- **00:12:52 Prosecutor's Office Budget & Salary Matrix Revision**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric (Prosecutor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Prosecutor presented a reworked pay matrix for deputy prosecutors addressing prior concerns regarding large salary jumps and gaps between year 1 and year 25. To triage recruitment and retention, the prosecutor agreed to cut two requested staff positions (\$129,200 plus benefits), lower the 20-year base salary on the matrix from \$126,350 to \$115,000, and remove specific deputy prosecutor stipends (\$15,500 general fund, \$15,000 LIT) totaling \$30,500. Specific line-item salaries across the general fund, LIT, and family support funds were verified and recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Presented and integrated into the budget planning models.
- **00:30:08 County Budget Scenario Modeling & Policy Discussions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jessica and Matt (Council/Budget Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented four proposed budget plans (Plans A, B, C, and D) focusing on County General fund cuts, salary study leveling vs. midpoint freezes, and public safety allocations.
 - *Health Insurance:* Staff and board discussed increasing the health insurance commissioner's line item by 10% (bringing it to \$3,486,615) to reflect actuarial realities and historical underfunding rather than relying on year-end appropriations.
 - *Highway/Bridge Personnel:* Discussed converting Highway Supervisor One to "Superintendent" (exempt, split half-and-half between bridge and motor vehicle/highway funds) and unfunding the Bridge Supervisor position while keeping the line item unallocated.
 - *Revenue Adjustments:* Noted adjustments in anticipated federal inmate revenue from the jail (suggesting an additional \$150,000 to \$200,000 to help bridge gaps for Plans C or D).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Comprehensive review of financial modeling and policy choices; consensus reached to have the auditor run numbers on Plans A and C

incorporating FICA and PERF.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:47:43 Gavin Green (Coroner):** Asked whether the council would appreciate department heads submitting cuts or utilizing wiggle room in their budgets to help expedite the budget adjustment process ahead of upcoming meetings. Council confirmed this was welcomed and encouraged via email.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council scheduled an intensive follow-up budget work session for **Wednesday the 18th at 8:30 a.m.** to work through department line items and review updated figures from the auditor's office.
 - Elected officials will be asked to attend an upcoming insurance round table to evaluate policy structures and potential cost-saving measures.
 - **Adjournment: 01:49:43** The meeting was recessed until Wednesday, September 18th, at 8:30 a.m. by Voice Vote / Unanimous consensus.
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